

It's official—Melissa Di Donato is SUSE's first female CEO

Accomplished technology executive and former SAP leader, Melissa Di Donato, has been named chief executive officer (CEO) of SUSE, the world's largest independent open source software company.

"UK based Di Donato will be SUSE's first female CEO, effective August 5," the company announced in an official statement.

Prior to SUSE, Di Donato was chief operating officer and chief revenue officer at SAP where she was responsible for the worldwide revenue, profit and customer satisfaction of the company's digital core solutions. She had earlier held senior executive positions at Salesforce and was recognised for her contributions to growing global organisations with the 2018 Digital Masters Award for Excellence in Commercial Management.



Di Donato is highly regarded for her forward-thinking leadership style and is a passionate advocate for workplace diversity. She is the Technology Group chair of the '30% Club' – an organisation with the goal of achieving 30 per cent female directors on S&P 100 boards by 2020.

She also holds prominent positions in other organisations, including Notion Capital, and is a trustee for the charity Founders4Schools.

"There is no greater honour than to lead SUSE into its next chapter of accelerated growth and corporate development," Di Donato said. "SUSE is at the cusp of a historic shift as open source software is now a critical part of any thriving enterprise's core business strategy. We are well positioned to emerge as the clear leader of this shift, with our ability to power digital transformation for our customers at their own pace and with agile, enterprise-grade open source solutions, edge to core to cloud," she added.

IBM releases AI and ML projects that aim to combat cancer, to the open source community

Researchers from IBM's Computational Systems Biology group in Zurich are using artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) to help improve our understanding of cancers and their treatment.

The tech giant has also made three such projects available to the open source community to allow other researchers and academics to contribute to their



development. "Our goal is to deepen our understanding of cancer to equip industries and academia with the knowledge that could potentially one day help fuel new treatments and therapies," sources at IBM have said.

The first project, dubbed PaccMann, is described as the 'The prediction of anti-cancer compound sensitivity with multi-modal attention-based neural networks'. The PaccMann algorithm is designed to automatically analyse chemical compounds and identify the one that is most likely to fight cancer strains. IBM says identifying potential anti-cancer compounds earlier can help cut the costs associated with drug development.

The second project is called 'Interaction Network inference from vector representations of words' or INtERAcT.

This tool aims to make the academic research easier by automatically extracting information from valuable scientific papers. Currently, the tool is being tested to extract data related to protein-protein interactions — an area of study that has been

CNCF's Security Audit Group exposes 34 vulnerabilities in Kubernetes

Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF) has released the Kubernetes security audit report on GitHub. Hosted by the CNCF, Kubernetes is an open source container orchestration engine for automating deployment, scaling and management of containerised applications.

Specifically, the audit team found 34 significant Kubernetes vulnerabilities—four were of high severity, 15 of medium severity, eight of low severity, and seven were of informational severity. Two of the nastiest bugs have already been fixed in new releases of Kubernetes 1.13.9, 1.14.5, and 1.15.2: CVE-2019-11247, and CVE-2019-11249.

The CNCF's Third Party Security Audit Working Group, in collaboration with Trail of Bits and Atredis Partners, completed the audit in four months.

Since Kubernetes is a huge project, with functionality running from API gateways and container orchestration to networking and beyond, the audit team selected eight of Kubernetes' most commonly used components for evaluation.

The team found that while Kubernetes is already widely deployed, it needs a lot of security work. Trail of Bits stated in its report: "The assessment team found configuration and deployment of Kubernetes to be non-trivial, with certain components having confusing default settings, missing operational controls, and implicitly designed security controls."

As for the code, it said, "the state of the Kubernetes codebase has significant room for improvement."

The first public audits identified security issues from general weaknesses to critical vulnerabilities. With these results, project maintainers for CoreDNS, Envoy and Prometheus were able to address the identified vulnerabilities and add documentation to help users.